

EVE ONLINE SUBSCRIPTION KPIS

> DATA SOURCES 25 > KPI COVERAGE 13 / 15 > RAW DATA 13 GB
> CHARACTERS TRACKED 889,560 > WINDOW Jan 24 - Aug 26 > DATABASE 35 tables · PostgreSQL

Repo: [anayaanj/bu7141-eve-online](#) (public). Every raw file is logged with URL, date, size and checksum in [data/raw/sources.csv](#). Retrieved 28 Sep - 7 Oct 2026.

[FINDINGS]

docs/story.md

THE QUESTION

EVE keeps its veterans like few games do, but loses almost every newcomer. Why, and what could keep them?

Most newcomers we see show up on a single day, and for most the only trace they leave is being killed by another player, alone. The few who come back were in a player group, in player-held space, or got a win, and they are the only newcomers who earn back what it cost to bring them in. Getting newcomers into groups in their first week is the strongest lead, and worth testing.

- 0 **What is EVE?** Wars, empires that rise and fall, 24,000 players online at once.
- 1 **The paradox.** Loyal veterans, vanishing newcomers.
- 2 **A newcomer's first day.** Seen once, killed by another player after leaving home.
- 3 **The few who come back.** In a group, in player space, or after a win.
- 4 **What it's worth.** Buying newcomers got pricier; only those in a group pay back their cost.
- 5 **Recommendation.** Protect and group newcomers in their first week, spend on keeping, and A/B test it.

CASUAL NEWCOMERS (SEEN ON ONE DAY) SEEN AGAIN 3 MONTHS LATER



84% vs 8-24%

Players EVE kept a year after its Steam peak, against big recent launches (New World, Throne and Liberty, Lost Ark).

1 in 100

Signups still playing a year later: 13% ever fight or trade with others, and 8.2% of those stay.

62%

Of the new players we can see appear on a single day in their first month.

\$16.25

Marketing cost per signup in 2025, up 56%: CCP spent 41% more and got 10% fewer signups.

8% vs 22%

Pandemic Horde's November 2025 newcomers still playing at month 3, as the alliance lost its space, against other alliances'.

0.6× vs 1.1×

First-year revenue per newcomer against what it cost to bring them in (estimate): alone in the starter corporation, against in a group with a win.

[DATA SOURCES]

all real · all public

SOURCE AND WHAT IT IS	PUBLISHER	ONE ROW IS	VOLUME
Killmails Record CCP creates whenever a ship is destroyed, shared publicly by players on zKillboard.	zKillboard / CCP, via EVE Ref	one ship destroyed, with victim and attackers	15.8M kills
Public contracts Item exchanges, auctions and courier jobs players post publicly.	CCP, via EVE Ref	one contract, with its items	4.7M
Characters and signups Public character profiles, plus CCP's ID sequence, which gives the exact number of characters created each month.	eve-kill.com, CCP API	one character; one month of signups	889,560 · 32 months
Static game data CCP's database of ships, items, the map with its stargate links, and the starter systems.	CCP SDE	one ship, item, system or link	5,485 systems
Who holds space The alliance holding each system, one snapshot of CCP's sovereignty map per day.	CCP API, via EVE Ref	one system and day	974 days · 2.6M

SOURCE AND WHAT IT IS	PUBLISHER	ONE ROW IS	VOLUME
Market and economy Daily PLEX and store-item trading, and CCP's Monthly Economic Reports.	CCP, via EVE Ref	one item, region and day; one indicator and day	974 days · 33 reports
Players online and wars Concurrent players, wars and sovereignty fights.	EVE Offline, CCP API	one day; one war or campaign	daily
Interest and sentiment Steam player counts and reviews, Twitch viewing, Google Trends, official forum threads.	SteamCharts, Valve, SullyGnome, Google, CCP forums	one month, review or post	39,555 reviews
Pricing, news and events Archived Omega and store pages, CCP news, patch history and lore events.	CCP, Wayback Machine	a price snapshot, article or event	68 prices · 15 plans
Financials Pearl Abyss quarterly reports (owner until May 2026) and CCP's audited annual accounts. They agree within 0.5%.	Pearl Abyss IR, Skatturinn	one quarter or fiscal year	87 figures
Other MMOs Steam players for 10 other MMOs, official peak subscriber figures, published new-player retention, and World of Warcraft activity measured our way.	SteamCharts, company press releases, WoWAH dataset	one game and metric	11 games
History and guides EVE's great wars, written in our own words with citations, and the official new player path.	Groen, <i>Empires of Eve</i> Vols. 1-2; EVE University wiki	one turning point	25 events
Field detail: docs/raw_inventory.md . ERD and normalization: docs/erd_design.md . Dashboard CSVs, ready for Tableau Public: data/exports/ .			

